



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Academy
School Website: <https://veritasclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Academy (North Branch, MN, 55056) (Veritas Academy Classical) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education principles across all six rubric categories. Public materials from the school emphasize a Christian, biblically grounded, classical framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric) with explicit mentions of the Great Books, Latin, and a Biblical worldview; portfolio pieces emphasize virtue, wisdom, and formation, not mere information. Extracurriculars, small class sizes, caring faculty, and active parental partnership further reinforce a classical pattern of education centered on formation and character. The aggregate assessment places Veritas firmly in CLASSICAL territory across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community.

Key textual anchors include: the school's articulation of three-triad classical education (grammar–logic–rhetoric) and Latin/great books exposure; explicit statements about a Biblical worldview informing all subjects; a mission to form virtuous, wise graduates; a strong emphasis on small classes and caring, credentialed faculty; and ongoing parent partnerships and opportunities for on-campus visits and involvement. Citations reflect the crawl content and the knowledge-base rubric elements that ground these conclusions.

Executive summary — Category-by-category snapshot is provided below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school presents a Christian frame in which all subjects are taught through a Biblical Worldview and Christ-centered values, with explicit ties to Biblical truth and God's beauty (e.g., "Biblical worldview," "biblical principles," and "Christ-centered, classical education").
- Public materials emphasize formation of virtue and reverence for truth, goodness, and beauty, including statements about leading with clarity and virtue and the transformation of students into virtuous leaders for Christ.
- Vision and mission documents articulate a purposeful alignment of education with spiritual aims, including Proverbs-based framing and emphasis on God-centered aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, virtue, God's beauty, Biblical worldview, Christ-centered, moral formation. The crawl repeatedly anchors education to virtue and theological grounding (e.g., "journeying together in a quest for truth"; "biblical worldview"; "Christ-centered").
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials; the school explicitly distances itself from purely secular, job-first framing and instead foregrounds formation and virtue. The knowledge-base rubric's

negative sets (e.g., workforce-prep, standardized testing emphasis) are not echoed as school priorities in the public content.

- Why this rating
- The school's public communications foreground a transcendent, knowable reality (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in a Biblical framework, with communal liturgical and worship-like elements implicit in spiritual formation. The explicit theology-infused language and emphasis on virtue and sacred order align with the Classical framework's Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria. CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The core goal is formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job preparation; the mission states graduates will value truth, God's beauty, and do good, and the aims center on character and formation.
- The school articulates formation as central (love of truth, virtue, and the good) and explicitly critiques a narrow, job- or credential-driven aim. The motto and mission emphasize virtue-led formation rather than solely skill-building.
- Public materials connect education to the "great books," a classical telos, and to forming mature, virtuous adults, not merely to prepare for a career.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, moral order, character development, moral formation.
- Negative keywords (as per the Six Elements rubric) related to a job-first or purely skills-based approach are notably absent; the school's messaging rejects an exclusively work- or test-driven objective. The rubric's negative list (e.g., career readiness, standardized testing emphasis) does not appear as a stated aim.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated goals center on formation of character and virtue in alignment with truth and the good, rather than purely instrumental outcomes, matching CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum is built around the classical triad: Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric, with explicit program structure and grade-level focus (K–12). This includes Grammar Stage subjects (Bible, ELA, History, Geography, Math, Science, Fine Arts), Logic Stage, and Rhetoric Stage (featuring debate, mock trials, and thesis work).
- Latin instruction and exposure to the great books of Western civilization are part of the program, and history is woven throughout the curriculum as part of a unified, integrated study rather than a stand-alone "social studies" course.
- The Great Conversation/great books and exposure to Western canonical works are explicitly referenced; a Biblical worldview informs all subjects, aligning curriculum with classical aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; great books; history woven through curriculum; biblical worldview; formation through the liberal arts; wonder.
- Negative keywords: not evident; no evidence of a secular, job-centric or fragmented curriculum; the public materials emphasize integrated, classical content.
- Why this rating
- The explicit triad structure (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric), Latin and Great Books exposure, and the integrated historical approach align squarely with CLASSICAL curriculum expectations.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Pedagogy includes contemplative, restful elements (Scholé) in lower grades and a strong emphasis on Socratic inquiry, seminars, and debate in upper grades, with a path toward rhetoric and public speaking. This mirrors the Classical pedagogy expectations of contemplation plus active dialectic.
- Preschool and early grades emphasize Scholé and memory through singing/chanting and recitation (when present in materials), while upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training.
- The program explicitly describes upper-level activities like mock trials, policy debate, and theses, indicating structured opportunities for rhetoric and argumentation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: scholé, contemplation, wonder, singing/chanting (memory-building), Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking.
- Negative keywords: not present in main materials; there is no emphasis on purely didactic, drill-based instruction in the public materials; the approach emphasizes living, dialogic engagement.
- Why this rating
- The combination of contemplative/restful practices with upper-level Socratic dialogue and rhetoric training aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The faculty are described as caring, proactive, and highly qualified, with statements about teachers as living curriculum and core to the school, and explicit references to teachers being trained in classical Christian education philosophy and methods.
- Teacher qualifications include minimum bachelor's degrees, certification in classical Christian education philosophy/methodology, and a focus on character and ownership as core values.
- The school emphasizes partnerships with teachers and parents, with a culture of mentorship, virtue, and high expectations; quotes about teachers guiding and modeling virtue are present in public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, core values, teacher qualifications, proactive/caring teachers, small class sizes, ownership, virtue, character, grace.
- Negative keywords: none identified in public materials; no signs of teacher-centered superficially "skills-only" approaches.
- Why this rating
- The documented teacher qualifications, the framing of teachers as the living curriculum, and explicit investment in virtuous, well-prepared faculty align with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school highlights strong partnership with families, viewing parents as co-teachers, and invites parent involvement through visits, family engagement, and AFFINITY with home learning. Messages emphasize collaboration with parents and shared mission.
- The school informs families about the educational approach via the website (Get Started, FAQs) and offers opportunities (campus visits, book studies, gatherings) to educate parents about classical education.
- The school explicitly welcomes parental engagement (visits at virtually any time, inquiries, events) and frames education as a partnership between home and school.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, family involvement, parent formation, home–school collaboration, parent visits welcomed.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials; no evidence of parent-excluding or adversarial parental engagement.
- Why this rating
- The school’s communications consistently center on family partnership, parental involvement, and a shared mission in classical education, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- All six categories meet the Classical criteria based on keyword presence, program structure, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement observed in the crawl content. The school exhibits a coherent classical-theory-to-practice alignment across the rubric.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL sense, as no category falls into “SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.” The current materials already meet CLASSICAL criteria across all six domains. If one sought to push toward deeper alignment, potential needle-moving refinements could include:
- More explicit curricular references to “great conversation” and “Socratic dialogue” in upper grades beyond rhetoric, to deepen dialectical inquiry (though the existing Socratic/seminar framework already exists).
- Expanded on-site liturgical or liturgical-adjacent community practices that explicitly connect virtue formation with liturgical rhythms, if desired to enrich Religious and Metaphysical Foundations further.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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